Who supplies U.S. military and NASA aerospace?

Supplier spend on real federal contract data. Tarang Jammalamadaka. Data: USAspending.gov, pulled October 2026.

Question. If I were buying for a defense aircraft program, how dependent is government aerospace spend on a few suppliers, which contract types carry the money, and how much of it is competed?

Data. 874,769 contract transactions: every NASA contract action and every DoD action in aerospace product and parts manufacturing (NAICS 3364), FY2021 to FY2025, including obligations on IDVs. $600.9B in total ($499.4B DoD, $101.5B NASA). Every agency-year reconciles to USAspending's own total to the cent. I rolled 11,227 supplier records (UEIs) up to parent companies with a 152-row crosswalk sourced to 10-K subsidiary lists and acquisition announcements; reviewed rows cover 92% of DoD dollars and 67% of NASA dollars.

Finding one: supplier records hide half the concentration. As reported, DoD's largest aerospace supplier record holds 21% of obligations and the top five hold 45% (HHI 671). Rolled up to parent companies, Lockheed Martin holds 43%, the top five hold 83%, and HHI is 2,368. For scale, the 2023 Merger Guidelines call a market above 1,800 highly concentrated. Across the five years Lockheed's DoD spend sits under 47 supplier records; in FY2025 alone its share goes from 26.3% for its largest record to 48.2% once they are combined. NASA's base is far less concentrated: top five 43%, HHI 476.

Finding two: contract type follows the kind of work. DoD puts 77% of aerospace dollars on fixed-price contracts (46% on firm fixed price alone) but only 27% of R&D dollars; 73% of R&D is cost-reimbursement, while products are 84% fixed-price. NASA runs the other way: 66% cost-type overall and 78% of R&D. Time and materials barely registers: 0.1% at DoD and 0.4% at NASA. The pattern tracks risk. Boeing's 10-K for 2025 reports $5,013 million of 2024 losses on its five major fixed-price development programs. Of DoD's $8.4B of fixed-price aerospace R&D, Lockheed holds 51%, Textron 31% and Boeing 11%.

Finding three: most DoD aerospace dollars are not competed. 87% of DoD obligations were not competed, and 78% of those cite "only one source" (FAR 6.302-1). 63% of DoD dollars went to actions that drew a single offer. For Lockheed Martin the not-competed share is 95%. At NASA it is 31%.

What I would do next as a buyer. First, measure supplier exposure at the parent level: the record level understates dependence by about half. Second, where competition is not available, the leverage moves to price analysis and contract terms, so track sole-source spend by supplier and contract type. Third, flag fixed-price development work for extra cost and schedule review.

Limits. These are obligations, net of deobligations, not outlays. NAICS 3364 understates DoD aerospace: a product-code definition raises the FY2025 top-five record share from 52% to 60%. Parents use today's owner for every year (Aerojet Rocketdyne counts under L3Harris), because USAspending records the parent as of each action, and its FFRDC flag misses JPL; both were corrected from primary sources. IDV obligations are 23.9% of NASA dollars and 0.0% of DoD dollars, so leaving them out would undercount NASA. HHI here measures one buyer's spend, not a market.

